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AMERICA JOINS MIDDLE EAST WAR

As world waits for mullahs' response to U.S. bombing raid

FEARS UK WILL NOW FACE IRAN TERROR BACKLASH



Direct orders: Donald Trump watches mission unfold from the White House situation room

IRAN'S nuclear ambitions have been 'totally obliterated' by the surprise American strikes, Donald Trump said last night.

The US President said the audacious attack by a squadron of

By **Mark Nicol, Harriet Line** and **Natalie Lisbona** in Jerusalem

stealth bombers in the early hours of yesterday had 'taken the bomb right out of [Tehran's] hands'.

But there are fears Britain and other allies could face a terror backlash from the regime's supporters.

Seven B-2 stealth bombers swept into Iranian airspace undetected yesterday, dropping 14 'bunker-buster' bombs on nuclear facilities as the US joined Israel in the biggest Western military action against the Islamic Republic since its 1979 revolution.

The UK was informed of the mission, codenamed Operation Midnight

Hammer, but played no part. Cabinet minister Jonathan Reynolds last night warned that Iranian activity in the UK was already substantial, and it was 'naïve' to think it won't escalate.

Britain's military bases in the region, such as RAF Akrotiri on Cyprus, were on the highest state of alert last night

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ANDREW NEIL ++ PETER HITCHENS ++ DAVID PATRIKARAKOS